

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Environmental Consulting English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For environmental consultants, remediation managers, sustainability analysts, field scientists, permitting specialists, ESG teams, and environmental project managers.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Phase I and Phase II Site Assessments

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

02 Sampling Plans and Data Quality

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

03 Permitting and Agency Coordination

Clarify missing information before responding.

04 Remediation Options and Risk

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

05 Regulatory Compliance and Audits

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

06 Sustainability and ESG Reporting

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

07 Community and Stakeholder Meetings

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

08 Proposal, Scope, and Client Expectations

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Phase I and Phase II Site Assessments

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A site-assessment summary says no further questions remain, but one historical record has not been obtained.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Phase I ESA - An environmental site assessment reviewing records and site information to identify relevant environmental concerns.

REC - Recognized environmental condition: a defined environmental-assessment term concerning hazardous substances or petroleum at a property.

Phase II - A further environmental investigation often involving sampling to assess concerns identified at a site.

due diligence - Structured review of facts, risks, obligations, and evidence before a transaction, onboarding, investment, or decision.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - B. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - C. The change must have caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - B. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
 - C. Across the service, the observed result was ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

One historical record is still missing

Fictional due-diligence review: a site-assessment summary says no questions remain, although one requested historical record is unavailable. This is language practice, not an environmental opinion.

01 • Assessment coordinator: The summary says no questions remain, but we haven't obtained the requested historical record.

02 • Project manager: The other records looked consistent. Can we reasonably assume the missing one adds nothing?

03 • Assessment coordinator: No. We can describe the reviewed material, but should preserve this specific evidence gap.

04 • Project manager: Then the Phase I ESA summary needs a limitation rather than an unconditional conclusion.

05 • Assessment coordinator: Yes. The qualified assessor should explain the gap's significance within the actual assessment scope.

06 • Project manager: Does missing information automatically establish a recognized environmental condition, or REC, for the property?

07 • Assessment coordinator: We shouldn't make that classification from the gap alone. It needs the appropriate professional assessment.

08 • Project manager: I'll request the record status and remove the claim that every question has been resolved.

09 • Assessment coordinator: Good. Also avoid announcing that Phase II work is unnecessary before the assessor addresses the limitation.

10 • Project manager: I'll keep the reviewed evidence, missing record, and pending professional conclusion separate in the update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A site visit is not subsurface sampling

Separate fictional due-diligence case: a site visit is complete; no subsurface samples were collected, and a draft describes the ground as tested.

01 • Client liaison: The visit is complete, so I described the site's ground conditions as tested in our summary.

02 • Environmental assessor: Please correct that. The visit didn't include subsurface sampling, so tested overstates what was done.

03 • Client liaison: What observation can I accurately report without making the completed site visit sound unhelpful?

04 • Environmental assessor: Say the visit occurred and describe its documented scope, without implying laboratory or subsurface results.

05 • Client liaison: Then a Phase I ESA and a proposed Phase II investigation aren't interchangeable labels here?

06 • Environmental assessor: Correct. Use the actual scope and qualified assessor's conclusions rather than treating all assessment work as sampling.

07 • Client liaison: Can we say no contamination exists because nothing unusual was recorded during the visit?

08 • Environmental assessor: That would exceed this evidence. Absence of an observed sign doesn't establish every subsurface condition.

09 • Client liaison: I'll remove tested and refer any further-investigation question to the assessor with the due-diligence records.

10 • Environmental assessor: Good. The client should understand both the completed work and the limits of what it establishes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A neighbor's record does not classify this property

Separate fictional assessment case: a historical record concerns a neighboring parcel; the relationship to the subject property has not been evaluated.

01 • Research assistant: I found a historical record for the neighboring parcel. Does it prove a REC on our site?

02 • Senior assessor: Not by itself. We need to verify location and assess relevance to the subject property.

03 • Research assistant: The street names match closely, so I assumed the record covered the same parcel.

04 • Senior assessor: Similar addresses aren't enough. Keep the parcel identification question explicit in the due-diligence notes.

05 • Research assistant: Should I exclude the record until we know whether it affects the assessment conclusion?

06 • Senior assessor: Preserve it as a potentially relevant source, with its location and significance clearly unverified.

07 • Research assistant: I'll request the mapped parcel reference and avoid classifying the site's condition from this document alone.

08 • Senior assessor: Good. Any implications for Phase II work belong in the qualified assessment, not a research shortcut.

09 • Research assistant: The summary will say a neighboring record was found and its relationship to this property needs review.

10 • Senior assessor: That accurately separates discovery of information from a supported environmental conclusion about the subject site.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Phase I and Phase II Site Assessments

A site-assessment summary says no further questions remain, but one historical record has not been obtained.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The review is incomplete because that historical record is missing. I'll identify the information gap and its significance for the assessment rather than imply that all relevant questions have been resolved.

Scenario 2 | An old assessment has a different boundary

A fictional client supplies an old site assessment covering the northern parcel only. The current purchase includes both northern and southern parcels. No assessment of the southern parcel is supplied. Discuss the document's scope and missing evidence.

Role A: Due-diligence coordinator: explain why the old report cannot automatically cover the whole purchase.

Role B: Client transaction manager: ask what the qualified assessor needs to review next.

Possible opening: The old report covers the northern parcel, but our current purchase also includes the southern parcel.

Success checks

- Identify the boundary mismatch.
- Preserve the old report's actual scope.
- Request qualified review of the unassessed portion.

Add a complication: The client asks you to relabel the old report as covering the combined property.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Sampling Plans and Data Quality

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A sample record omits a transfer signature. The laboratory result is available, but the chain-of-custody record needs review.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

sampling plan - A plan specifying what will be sampled, where, when, and by which method.

chain of custody - A documented record of who handled a sample or item and when it changed hands.

detection limit - The lowest amount or concentration reliably distinguished from absence under a specified method.

QA/QC - Quality assurance and quality control: processes for establishing quality and checking specific results.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - B. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
 - C. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm that the review is important?
 - B. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?
 - C. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A missing transfer signature needs review

Fictional sampling-record case: laboratory results are available, but the chain-of-custody record lacks a transfer signature; data usability is not determined here.

01 • Project chemist: Could you review the missing transfer signature on this chain-of-custody record before our data review?

02 • Field coordinator: The laboratory result is already available. Which specific information do you need from the field team?

03 • Project chemist: Please identify the transfer record and provide any existing supporting documentation through the approved review process.

04 • Field coordinator: Should I simply add a signature now so the paperwork looks complete for the client?

05 • Project chemist: No. Don't reconstruct an undocumented transfer as established fact. The gap needs transparent QA/QC review.

06 • Field coordinator: I'll locate the original records and explain what is available, without filling in unsupported details.

07 • Project chemist: Thank you. We need the reviewer to assess the gap's effect on the sampling evidence.

08 • Field coordinator: Can you confirm whether the missing signature automatically makes the laboratory result unusable?

09 • Project chemist: That conclusion isn't established here. The qualified data reviewer must evaluate the circumstances and applicable requirements.

10 • Field coordinator: I'll request the supporting record promptly and confirm retrieval timing rather than promise an unsupported resolution.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Request the reporting limit behind a nondetect

Separate fictional laboratory discussion: a result is labeled nondetect, but the reporting information needed to interpret that label is missing from the supplied extract.

01 • Environmental analyst: Could you provide the reporting information behind this nondetect result, including the relevant detection-limit details?

02 • Laboratory liaison: Do you need the complete result report rather than the abbreviated extract in the project folder?

03 • Environmental analyst: Yes. The client review needs the method and limit context, not just the abbreviated label.

04 • Laboratory liaison: Can the draft say the substance is absent while I retrieve the complete report?

05 • Environmental analyst: No. Nondetect doesn't establish absolute absence, and the supplied extract lacks important interpretation context.

06 • Laboratory liaison: I'll request the complete authorized report and keep the sample identifier linked to the request.

07 • Environmental analyst: Please also identify any qualifiers in that report so the QA/QC reviewer can assess them.

08 • Laboratory liaison: I can confirm availability after checking with the records team, but cannot promise immediate retrieval.

09 • Environmental analyst: That's fine. Tell us an achievable update point because the interpretation review depends on those details.

10 • Laboratory liaison: I'll return the verified documentation or state precisely what remains unavailable for the reviewer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A duplicate label needs a sample match

Separate fictional sampling case: two labels in a field log use the same sample identifier, while the sampling plan lists distinct locations.

01 • Data quality coordinator: Two field-log entries share one identifier. Could you check them against the original sampling records?

02 • Field team lead: The sampling plan lists separate locations. Are you asking which collected sample belongs to each location?

03 • Data quality coordinator: Exactly. We need an evidence-backed match before the laboratory results are interpreted by location.

04 • Field team lead: Can I rename one entry using the planned sequence to make the identifiers unique?

05 • Data quality coordinator: Not based only on sequence. Preserve the originals and follow the documented discrepancy-review process.

06 • Field team lead: I'll collect the existing labels, field notes, and chain-of-custody records for the authorized reviewer.

07 • Data quality coordinator: Please explain which match remains uncertain and ask when the review can provide a status.

08 • Field team lead: Should we call the sampling plan incorrect before that review establishes where the duplication occurred?

09 • Data quality coordinator: No. The observed issue is duplicate identifiers in the log; its source remains unconfirmed.

10 • Field team lead: I'll make that precise request and keep any location assignment pending until supported by the records.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Sampling Plans and Data Quality

A sample record omits a transfer signature. The laboratory result is available, but the chain-of-custody record needs review.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could the responsible team review the missing transfer record and document the resolution? I'll flag the gap in the data-quality discussion instead of treating the paperwork as complete.

Scenario 2 | A laboratory qualifier is missing from the table

A fictional laboratory report includes a qualifier on sample S4, but the client summary omits it. Its meaning has not been checked. Request the qualified reviewer's explanation before the result is presented without qualification.

Role A: Project analyst: identify S4 as the affected sample and request the complete qualifier text and its interpretation.

Role B: Laboratory liaison: obtain the authorized explanation without inventing its significance.

Possible opening: Could you clarify the qualifier on S4 and how it should appear in the client summary?

Success checks

- Preserve the laboratory result and qualifier.
- Ask for interpretation from the appropriate reviewer.
- Keep data usability unresolved until reviewed.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to delete the qualifier from both places because it looks confusing.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Permitting and Agency Coordination

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

An agency comment requests additional modeling but does not specify which scenario the team believes is missing.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

permit - Official permission for an activity under specified requirements.

agency comment - A question, observation, or requested change from a reviewing public agency.

public notice - A formal announcement made available to the public about an action or process.

modeling - Creating a representation of a system or outcome using stated relationships and assumptions.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - B. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - C. Could you confirm when the review starts?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - B. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - C. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Which modeling scenario is missing?

Fictional agency coordination: a comment asks for additional modeling but does not identify the scenario the team believes is missing.

01 • Permitting consultant: The agency comment requests additional modeling. Could you clarify which scenario needs to be addressed?

02 • Agency liaison: The comment doesn't identify it clearly, so I need to confirm that with the reviewer.

03 • Permitting consultant: Our team assumed it meant the highest-output scenario, but that is only an interpretation.

04 • Agency liaison: Please keep that assumption out of the confirmed response scope until we obtain clarification.

05 • Permitting consultant: Should the clarification request identify the scenarios already included in the submitted permit package?

06 • Agency liaison: Yes. That gives the reviewer a concrete reference and may help distinguish an omission from a labeling issue.

07 • Permitting consultant: Does the additional request mean the permit will definitely be refused without a full redesign?

08 • Agency liaison: That outcome isn't established. We should clarify the requested analysis rather than predict the decision.

09 • Permitting consultant: I'll summarize the submitted scenarios and ask which additional case and output the reviewer wants.

10 • Agency liaison: I'll route that focused question and keep the modeling scope pending until the response is verified.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A comment number without a document version

Separate fictional permit review: an agency message references comment 7, but two reviewed document versions use that number for different subjects.

01 • Project consultant: Could you confirm which document version comment seven refers to in the latest agency message?

02 • Permitting coordinator: Why is the version important? I thought the comment number identified the required response.

03 • Project consultant: Both versions contain comment seven, but they address different subjects, so the reference is ambiguous.

04 • Permitting coordinator: Then we need the reviewed version and relevant text before assigning a technical response.

05 • Project consultant: Exactly. Otherwise the modeling team could answer a different question from the one actually raised.

06 • Permitting coordinator: Should we respond to both comments just to avoid asking the agency for clarification?

07 • Project consultant: That may create unnecessary scope and still leave the current request unclear. Let's verify it first.

08 • Permitting coordinator: I'll request the version reference and quote the two possible subjects without choosing one.

09 • Project consultant: Please also keep the permit-status update separate from this administrative clarification of the comment.

10 • Permitting coordinator: Agreed. We'll assign the response once the actual referenced comment is confirmed by the liaison.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Public notice timing or approval timing?

Separate fictional agency-meeting preparation: a calendar entry says notice date, but the team has not established whether it refers to publication or a response deadline.

01 • Stakeholder coordinator: The permit calendar says notice date. Does that mean publication day or the deadline for responses?

02 • Agency liaison: The label doesn't tell us. We should confirm the meaning against the relevant notice.

03 • Stakeholder coordinator: I nearly told the client it was the approval date because it's the only date shown.

04 • Agency liaison: Please don't. None of those meanings is established by the calendar label alone.

05 • Stakeholder coordinator: Could you obtain the current public notice and identify which event this calendar entry represents?

06 • Agency liaison: Yes. I'll ask the document owner for the verified notice and the source of the entry.

07 • Stakeholder coordinator: Then I'll distinguish publication, response timing, and decision status rather than combine them in the briefing.

08 • Agency liaison: Good. Also avoid supplying a general legal deadline that isn't verified for this particular case.

09 • Stakeholder coordinator: I'll keep the ambiguous date unconfirmed and ask the client not to rely on my earlier assumption.

10 • Agency liaison: We'll confirm the meaning before circulating the schedule, with any unresolved permit decision clearly separate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Permitting and Agency Coordination

An agency comment requests additional modeling but does not specify which scenario the team believes is missing.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Could we confirm which scenario and supporting information the comment refers to? I'll draft a focused clarification question and identify our proposed response for review.

Scenario 2 | The agency asks for an updated map

A fictional agency comment requests an updated map without specifying whether it needs the revised project boundary or new sampling locations. Both changes exist in draft. Clarify the requested content before the map team proceeds.

Role A: Environmental project coordinator: ask which mapped changes and version the comment concerns.

Role B: Agency liaison: acknowledge the ambiguity and seek the reviewer's clarification.

Possible opening: Could you clarify whether updated map refers to the project boundary, the sampling locations, or both?

Success checks

- Identify the two possible meanings.
- Seek confirmation without silently expanding scope.
- Distinguish a revised submission from agency approval.

Add a complication: The client wants the map described as agency-approved as soon as it is revised.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Remediation Options and Risk

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

Two remediation options have different implementation times and monitoring needs. A client asks which is simply "best."

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

remediation - Work to correct a problem or reduce its effects; in environmental work, addressing contamination.

exposure pathway - The route by which a contaminant can reach a person or other receptor.

cap - A covering used in some remediation approaches to limit contact with contaminated material.

long-term monitoring - Repeated observation or measurement over an extended period to track conditions.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of one percentage point.
 - B. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.
 - C. An increase of seven percentage points.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Faster implementation, longer monitoring

Fictional comparison for language practice: option A is estimated at four weeks with three years of monitoring; B at twelve weeks with one year. Suitability and other costs need professional review.

01 • Client project lead: Option A takes four weeks and B takes twelve. Is A simply the best remediation choice?

02 • Remediation consultant: Not from timing alone. A includes three years of monitoring, while B includes one in these estimates.

03 • Client project lead: So the same comparison needs implementation time and long-term monitoring for both options.

04 • Remediation consultant: Yes, plus cost and qualified assessment of suitability for the site's actual conditions.

05 • Client project lead: Can I infer that the shorter monitoring period means B removes every exposure pathway?

06 • Remediation consultant: No. Those durations don't establish that conclusion, and neither option's technical suitability is settled here.

07 • Client project lead: Then the visible tradeoff is quicker implementation versus a longer stated monitoring commitment.

08 • Remediation consultant: Correct, within these fictional estimates. We shouldn't call either option universally safer or more effective.

09 • Client project lead: I'll ask for a matched comparison of remaining costs, assumptions, and site-specific requirements.

10 • Remediation consultant: That will support a qualified decision instead of choosing from one attractive number in isolation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A cap proposal needs defined comparison criteria

Separate fictional client meeting: a cap concept and an excavation concept are under preliminary review; no cost, safety, or suitability conclusion has been established.

01 • Property redevelopment manager: The cap concept sounds simpler than excavation. Can we recommend it to the client now?

02 • Environmental options analyst: We need comparable criteria first: implementation, ongoing obligations, disruption, cost, and the assessed exposure pathways.

03 • Property redevelopment manager: Would lower visible construction activity automatically mean less long-term responsibility for the property owner?

04 • Environmental options analyst: No. The concept descriptions don't establish that, especially while long-term monitoring requirements remain unassessed.

05 • Property redevelopment manager: Then we should ask the qualified team to explain each option's ongoing obligations on the same basis.

06 • Environmental options analyst: Yes, and identify uncertainty rather than turn a preliminary concept into a final remediation recommendation.

07 • Property redevelopment manager: Could we present a preference based on the client's wish to reduce near-term disruption?

08 • Environmental options analyst: You can state that preference as a criterion, not claim it establishes technical acceptability.

09 • Property redevelopment manager: I'll separate the client's operational preference from the professional suitability review and missing cost information.

10 • Environmental options analyst: Good. That makes the tradeoff explicit without offering an unsupported environmental or safety conclusion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Different monitoring scopes hide the real cost

Separate fictional comparison: proposal A includes quarterly reports for two years; B's lower quoted price includes only one annual report. The technical monitoring plan is not being selected here.

01 • Client procurement manager: Proposal B costs less. Can we say it provides the same monitoring service for less money?

02 • Environmental project manager: The reporting scopes differ. A includes quarterly reports for two years; B includes one annual report.

03 • Client procurement manager: Then the headline prices aren't comparing equal deliverables, even before we review technical requirements.

04 • Environmental project manager: Exactly. We should align the requested scope before evaluating cost and long-term monitoring commitments.

05 • Client procurement manager: Could we divide the totals by report count and choose whichever has the lower unit price?

06 • Environmental project manager: That still wouldn't establish comparable content or suitability. Reports can cover different work and evidence.

07 • Client procurement manager: I'll request matching deliverables and clear exclusions from both teams for the same review period.

08 • Environmental project manager: Good. Keep the qualified remediation requirements separate from procurement's preference for a lower price.

09 • Client procurement manager: We'll present the price difference alongside the scope difference rather than call B an equivalent substitute.

10 • Environmental project manager: That gives the client an honest comparison and identifies what must be clarified before choosing.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Remediation Options and Risk

Two remediation options have different implementation times and monitoring needs. A client asks which is simply "best."

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The options address the problem in different ways and have different monitoring needs. Let's compare them against the agreed objectives and site conditions before recommending a preferred approach.

Scenario 2 | Compare disruption on the same calendar

Two fictional remediation schedules use different units: A states twenty working days, B states four calendar weeks. Access restrictions and start dates are unknown. Discuss why these figures alone do not establish which is faster for the client.

Role A: Project planner: identify the differing time bases and missing assumptions.

Role B: Client operations manager: ask for a comparable schedule and state the importance of access continuity.

Possible opening: The schedules use different time bases, so we need matching assumptions before calling one faster.

Success checks

- Distinguish working days from calendar weeks.
- Ask for matching schedule and access assumptions.
- Avoid guaranteeing operational continuity or technical suitability.

Add a complication: The client wants you to guarantee uninterrupted access without an assessed access plan.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Regulatory Compliance and Audits

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A compliance review has six findings. Four have documented corrective actions; two still lack an assigned owner.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

compliance audit - An examination of evidence against applicable rules or organizational requirements.

corrective action - Action taken to fix a current problem and prevent recurrence.

recordkeeping - Creating, organizing, maintaining, and retaining required records.

inspection - An examination of an item or condition against relevant requirements.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team has completed the review.
 - B. The team is completing the review.
 - C. The team plans to complete the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.
 - B. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - C. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Four actions documented, two owners missing

Fictional compliance review: six findings exist; four have documented corrective actions and two have no assigned owner. Verification of effectiveness is not supplied.

01 • Compliance coordinator: Six findings are recorded. Four have documented corrective actions, and two still lack an assigned owner.

02 • Client compliance manager: Can I call four findings closed and the audit nearly finished in the management update?

03 • Compliance coordinator: Documented actions don't automatically establish closure. We haven't supplied verification of their completion or effectiveness here.

04 • Client compliance manager: Then what should the update say about the four without overlooking the progress already made?

05 • Compliance coordinator: Their corrective actions are documented. The two owner assignments remain open and need management attention.

06 • Client compliance manager: I'll identify those gaps instead of saying the entire recordkeeping issue has been resolved.

07 • Compliance coordinator: Good. Ask the authorized owners for the next verified action status and any required review evidence.

08 • Client compliance manager: Does the absence of an owner prove the underlying issue was deliberately ignored by staff?

09 • Compliance coordinator: No. It establishes an assignment gap, not anyone's intention. Keep the compliance-audit language factual.

10 • Client compliance manager: I'll report documented plans, missing owners, and pending verification as distinct parts of the current status.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Inspection completed, evidence review pending

Separate fictional audit case: a facility inspection visit is complete, but photographs and maintenance records have not yet been reviewed against the findings.

01 • Facility manager: The inspection visit is over. Can the dashboard show the compliance review as complete?

02 • Audit reviewer: The visit is complete, but the supporting photographs and maintenance records still need review.

03 • Facility manager: I thought the visit covered everything. What remains open in the evidence review specifically?

04 • Audit reviewer: We need to compare those records with the recorded observations before finalizing the findings.

05 • Facility manager: Then we shouldn't tell management there are no outstanding issues just because the reviewers left site.

06 • Audit reviewer: Correct. Physical attendance and a completed compliance-audit assessment are different milestones in this case.

07 • Facility manager: I'll make the available records accessible through the agreed channel and identify any retrieval gaps.

08 • Audit reviewer: Thank you. Don't fill missing records with reconstructed entries presented as original evidence.

09 • Facility manager: I'll report the visit as completed and the document review as pending, with retrieval status included.

10 • Audit reviewer: That is a clear update and leaves the final conclusions with the qualified review process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Training attendance does not close the finding

Separate fictional corrective-action case: a recordkeeping training session is delivered, but a planned sample check of later records has not occurred.

01 • Corrective action coordinator: The recordkeeping training was delivered yesterday. Can we report the finding as fully resolved?

02 • Quality reviewer: The training is complete, but the planned sample check of later records hasn't occurred.

03 • Corrective action coordinator: So attendance evidence shows delivery, not whether the revised practice is working in subsequent records.

04 • Quality reviewer: Exactly. We need to distinguish implementation from verification in the compliance update.

05 • Corrective action coordinator: Would saying the training prevented future errors be too strong before we have that evidence?

06 • Quality reviewer: Yes. We haven't established future performance, and no training session guarantees that errors cannot recur.

07 • Corrective action coordinator: I'll provide the attendance evidence and ask the review owner to confirm the sample-check plan.

08 • Quality reviewer: Please include the plan's current status rather than invent a completion date for the review.

09 • Corrective action coordinator: The update will say training delivered, follow-up sampling pending, and closure not yet confirmed.

10 • Quality reviewer: Good. That recognizes completed work while preserving the evidence needed for a defensible closure decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Regulatory Compliance and Audits

A compliance review has six findings. Four have documented corrective actions; two still lack an assigned owner.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: Four findings have documented actions. Two still need owners and target dates. I'll make those open decisions visible in the review update and distinguish planned actions from completed ones.

Scenario 2 | A corrective action changes owner

A fictional audit action was assigned to a manager who has moved departments. The action remains open, and the proposed replacement has not accepted it. Give a status update and request confirmed reassignment.

Role A: Compliance coordinator: describe the open action and unaccepted reassignment.

Role B: Department lead: ask what evidence and responsibility transfer are needed.

Possible opening: The action remains open, and the proposed new owner has not yet accepted responsibility.

Success checks

- Separate reassignment from action completion.
- Identify the missing acceptance.
- Agree who will confirm ownership and correct the misleading status.

Add a complication: The dashboard automatically shows reassigned as complete.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Sustainability and ESG Reporting

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A sustainability draft says the company is carbon neutral, but the supporting calculation covers only selected operations.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

ESG - Environmental, social, and governance factors considered in organizational reporting or decisions.

Scope 1 - Direct greenhouse-gas emissions from sources owned or controlled by the reporting organization under the chosen framework.

Scope 2 - Indirect greenhouse-gas emissions from generating purchased or acquired energy used by the reporting organization.

Scope 3 - Other indirect greenhouse-gas emissions in an organization's value chain under the relevant reporting framework.

carbon neutral - A claim about balancing specified carbon emissions with removals or offsets within a stated boundary and period.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Selected operations do not support a company-wide claim

Fictional sustainability review: a carbon-neutral claim is drafted, but the supporting calculation covers selected operations only; no certification or claim validity is established.

01 • Sustainability communications manager: The draft calls the company carbon neutral, but the calculation covers only selected operations.

02 • ESG analyst: Then the claim exceeds the evidence boundary. We need to identify exactly what was included.

03 • Sustainability communications manager: Could we keep the headline and put the limited scope in a small note below?

04 • ESG analyst: A broad headline would still mislead. The main wording should reflect the actual assessed boundary.

05 • Sustainability communications manager: The calculation mentions Scope 1 and Scope 2. Does that establish all Scope 3 emissions too?

06 • ESG analyst: No. Those categories aren't interchangeable, and we must not infer coverage absent from the calculation.

07 • Sustainability communications manager: I'll remove the company-wide conclusion and request the qualified review of any narrower proposed claim.

08 • ESG analyst: Good. A limited calculation alone doesn't establish that even the narrower carbon-neutral wording is justified.

09 • Sustainability communications manager: We'll report what was calculated and identify unassessed operations rather than announce a verified status.

10 • ESG analyst: That keeps the ESG communication tied to evidence instead of using an unsupported environmental label.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A smaller footprint may reflect a smaller boundary

Separate fictional emissions comparison: this year's inventory excludes a sold facility that was included last year; a like-for-like comparison has not been prepared.

01 • Sustainability director: Our reported emissions fell. Can we say every operation became more efficient this year?

02 • Inventory analyst: The reporting boundary changed: this year excludes a sold facility that last year's inventory included.

03 • Sustainability director: So the lower total may partly reflect fewer operations rather than improved performance at each site.

04 • Inventory analyst: Exactly. We need a consistent comparison before attributing the change to efficiency measures.

05 • Sustainability director: Would combining Scope 1 and Scope 2 totals remove the effect of that boundary change?

06 • Inventory analyst: No. Adding categories doesn't restore the missing facility to the comparison or establish like-for-like performance.

07 • Sustainability director: I'll label the boundary change and ask for an analysis using comparable operations where appropriate.

08 • Inventory analyst: Good. Keep any Scope 3 questions separate and don't imply those emissions were assessed here.

09 • Sustainability director: The ESG update will report the observed total and its changed coverage, not universal operational improvement.

10 • Inventory analyst: That allows readers to understand the reduction without drawing a stronger conclusion than the inventory supports.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A supplier survey is not verified emissions data

Separate fictional ESG case: thirty suppliers answered a questionnaire, but their emissions figures have not been checked and the remaining suppliers have not responded.

01 • Procurement sustainability lead: Thirty suppliers responded. Can we call our Scope 3 data collection complete and verified?

02 • ESG data reviewer: No. Other suppliers haven't responded, and the submitted figures haven't been checked yet.

03 • Procurement sustainability lead: Then the response count shows participation, not complete coverage or reliable totals for the inventory.

04 • ESG data reviewer: Correct. We should report the responses received, missing coverage, and verification status separately.

05 • Procurement sustainability lead: Could unanswered questionnaires be entered as zero emissions so the reporting table can be finished?

06 • ESG data reviewer: No. Missing data aren't evidence of zero emissions; the appropriate methodology must address gaps transparently.

07 • Procurement sustainability lead: I'll ask the reporting specialist how to handle missing information rather than invent numerical values.

08 • ESG data reviewer: Good. Also preserve the suppliers' stated boundaries and assumptions when reviewing their submissions.

09 • Procurement sustainability lead: I'll revise the update to thirty responses received, with coverage and data-quality review still open.

10 • ESG data reviewer: That is a defensible collection status, not an unsupported claim of a verified Scope 3 inventory.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Sustainability and ESG Reporting

A sustainability draft says the company is carbon neutral, but the supporting calculation covers only selected operations.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The calculation does not yet support that broad claim. I'll state the included operations and reporting boundary clearly, then route the proposed wording for the appropriate review.

Scenario 2 | A renewable-energy claim uses an unreviewed document

A fictional company has received a supplier document about electricity sourcing, but its dates and covered sites have not been checked. A draft calls every office fully renewable. Discuss the evidence needed before making that claim.

Role A: ESG reviewer: identify the unverified dates and site coverage.

Role B: Communications lead: propose a status statement that does not claim verified sourcing.

Possible opening: We have the supplier document, but its dates and site coverage haven't been verified against the proposed claim.

Success checks

- Distinguish document receipt from evidence verification.
- Identify dates and site coverage as open questions.
- Avoid company-wide claims from unreviewed material.

Add a complication: A manager wants the claim used immediately because the supplier logo looks authoritative.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Community and Stakeholder Meetings

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

Residents ask whether a preliminary result proves that an entire area is safe. Sampling covered only specified locations and conditions.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

stakeholder - Person or group with an interest, risk, authority, or dependency in the work.

plume - An area of contamination spreading through a medium such as groundwater or air.

exposure - The extent to which people, assets, or operations are subject to a hazard or potential loss.

risk communication - Explaining a risk, its evidence, uncertainty, and relevant response to an audience.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
 - B. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - C. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - B. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - C. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A sampled location is not the whole area

Fictional community-meeting preparation: preliminary sampling covers specified locations and conditions; no area-wide safety conclusion is supplied.

01 • Community liaison: Residents ask whether the preliminary results prove the entire area is safe for everyone.

02 • Environmental project lead: The results concern the sampled locations and conditions, not every place or possible exposure.

03 • Community liaison: How can I explain that without making the information sound useless to the stakeholder group?

04 • Environmental project lead: Say what was sampled and what the results describe, then explain what lies outside that scope.

05 • Community liaison: Could I compare it to checking selected points rather than inspecting every part of the area?

06 • Environmental project lead: Yes, provided the comparison doesn't imply a technical conclusion the qualified assessment hasn't established.

07 • Community liaison: Should we call any untested location dangerous because we cannot provide an area-wide reassurance?

08 • Environmental project lead: No. Untested means information is missing, not that either safety or danger has been established.

09 • Community liaison: I'll acknowledge the concern and direct location-specific exposure questions to the qualified review team.

10 • Environmental project lead: Good risk communication explains useful evidence and its limits without replacing uncertainty with reassurance or alarm.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A plume map is not a personal exposure record

Separate fictional stakeholder briefing: a preliminary map shows a modeled plume extent, but individual exposure information is not available.

01 • Stakeholder meeting facilitator: People may think the plume map shows exactly what each resident has been exposed to.

02 • Environmental scientist: It doesn't. This preliminary map represents a modeled distribution, not an individual's measured exposure history.

03 • Stakeholder meeting facilitator: Could you explain the distinction in words that residents can repeat without technical training?

04 • Environmental scientist: A map can indicate where a substance may be distributed; personal exposure depends on additional information.

05 • Stakeholder meeting facilitator: Then living near a shaded area doesn't itself establish a particular health outcome for someone.

06 • Environmental scientist: Correct. We must avoid making personal health conclusions from this preliminary environmental map.

07 • Stakeholder meeting facilitator: Should I ask the team to explain the map boundary, assumptions, and remaining uncertainty before questions?

08 • Environmental scientist: Yes. Those details help stakeholders understand what the figure does and doesn't show.

09 • Stakeholder meeting facilitator: I'll invite specific concerns and route personal exposure questions to the appropriate qualified professionals.

10 • Environmental scientist: Good. The meeting should clarify the evidence, not use a diagram as a substitute for individual assessment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A screening value is not a complete risk conclusion

Separate fictional risk-communication rehearsal: a table compares preliminary results with a screening value; the qualified risk assessment remains open.

01 • Client communications officer: The table includes a screening value. Can I describe that number as the boundary between safe and unsafe?

02 • Risk communication specialist: That would oversimplify its role. We need the qualified reviewer to explain its purpose and applicability.

03 • Client communications officer: How can I introduce the table without giving the stakeholder audience a misleading shortcut?

04 • Risk communication specialist: Describe it as part of the review, not a complete determination of every exposure or risk.

05 • Client communications officer: Then the comparison supports questions for assessment rather than a universal conclusion about the entire site.

06 • Risk communication specialist: Exactly. Sampling scope, conditions, and the relevant interpretation all matter to the actual conclusion.

07 • Client communications officer: I'll avoid saying a single number proves no concern or confirms harm for every resident.

08 • Risk communication specialist: Good. Ask the reviewer to explain the applicable meaning in plain language before the public meeting.

09 • Client communications officer: I'll also state that the risk assessment is ongoing and collect questions about the reviewed locations.

10 • Risk communication specialist: That keeps the discussion useful while leaving technical and health conclusions with the appropriate qualified review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Community and Stakeholder Meetings

Residents ask whether a preliminary result proves that an entire area is safe. Sampling covered only specified locations and conditions.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The result describes the sampled locations and conditions. It does not answer every question about the wider area. We should explain the findings, their limits, and the next planned information step clearly.

Scenario 2 | A result applies to one season

A fictional community report contains samples collected during one dry-season visit. A resident asks whether it describes conditions throughout the year. No seasonal comparison is available. Explain the sampling boundary and agree a follow-up question.

Role A: Environmental liaison: explain what the single visit establishes without predicting other seasons.

Role B: Community association coordinator: paraphrase the limitation and ask what further assessment could clarify it.

Possible opening: These results describe the sampled conditions during one visit, not a measured comparison across every season.

Success checks

- State the single-visit boundary plainly.
- Avoid universal safety or danger claims.
- Refer the seasonal question for qualified assessment.

Add a complication: The coordinator asks for a yes-or-no assurance about all future conditions.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Proposal, Scope, and Client Expectations

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

SITUATION

A client requests additional sampling outside the agreed scope. The team has not assessed the extra time and cost.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

scope - Defined boundary of work, responsibility, deliverables, assumptions, and exclusions.

assumption - Something treated as true for planning or reasoning, though it may need verification.

deliverable - A specified item of work to be provided to a customer or project recipient.

change order - A documented modification to agreed construction work, often affecting price or time.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Compare this wording: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Offer a workable tradeoff

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
 - A. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
 - B. If the scope will change, we will review the schedule.
 - C. If the scope changes, we reviewed the schedule.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
 - A. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
 - B. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.
 - C. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Additional samples need a scope review

Fictional proposal discussion: a client requests additional sampling beyond the agreed scope; extra time, cost, and technical requirements are unassessed.

01 • Client project manager: Could you add samples from the adjacent area and keep the same price and delivery date?

02 • Environmental project manager: We can assess that addition, but its cost, timing, and technical requirements haven't been reviewed.

03 • Client project manager: The team will already be nearby. Doesn't that make the additional sampling part of the existing scope?

04 • Environmental project manager: Location alone doesn't establish inclusion. The agreed scope identifies the work and deliverables already authorized.

05 • Client project manager: What choices can I discuss with our budget owner before you assess the request?

06 • Environmental project manager: Keep the current scope, or request a change-order proposal for the additional area.

07 • Client project manager: If we request that proposal, will the original deliverable automatically include the new results?

08 • Environmental project manager: Not automatically. Integration, timing, and approval need to be addressed in the assessed change.

09 • Client project manager: I'll ask for the proposal and keep the extra work unapproved until our review is complete.

10 • Environmental project manager: I'll document the request and assumptions without promising unchanged cost or an unsupported delivery date.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An early briefing versus a final report

Separate fictional client case: a final report is pending qualified review; the team can assess an interim verbal briefing of verified progress without releasing final conclusions.

01 • Client transaction coordinator: Can you give our board the final conclusions tomorrow even though the report is still under review?

02 • Consulting project lead: I can't promise unapproved conclusions. We can consider an interim briefing limited to verified progress.

03 • Client transaction coordinator: Would that briefing include the same assurance the final deliverable is expected to provide?

04 • Consulting project lead: No. It would identify completed work and open questions, not substitute for the reviewed report.

05 • Client transaction coordinator: Then the tradeoff is earlier status information with clearly limited scope, rather than early final conclusions.

06 • Consulting project lead: Exactly. We also need to confirm availability for the briefing before committing to tomorrow.

07 • Client transaction coordinator: I'll ask the board whether that limited verbal update meets its immediate needs.

08 • Consulting project lead: Please do. Any additional analysis they request may require a separate scope and timing assessment.

09 • Client transaction coordinator: I'll describe the proposed briefing accurately and avoid calling it the final environmental opinion.

10 • Consulting project lead: Good. We'll agree its boundaries and availability without changing the final deliverable's review requirements.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A new audience changes the presentation scope

Separate fictional proposal case: a consultant's scope includes one technical client meeting; the client requests two public stakeholder sessions with new presentation material.

01 • Client engagement manager: Could you replace the technical meeting with two public sessions and prepare new presentation material?

02 • Consultant project director: We can assess that change, but the number of sessions and preparation scope are different.

03 • Client engagement manager: Could we call them the same deliverable because they discuss the same environmental project?

04 • Consultant project director: The subject is the same, but audience, format, preparation, and meeting count affect the work.

05 • Client engagement manager: What option would keep the original agreement intact while we consider the public sessions?

06 • Consultant project director: Retain the technical meeting, or request a reviewed change proposal for the two public sessions.

07 • Client engagement manager: If we choose the second option, can you guarantee both sessions fit the existing fee?

08 • Consultant project director: Not before assessing the change. We need explicit assumptions, deliverables, timing, and authorization.

09 • Client engagement manager: I'll seek approval to obtain the proposal and tell the community team the sessions aren't confirmed.

10 • Consultant project director: I'll prepare the scope assessment request and keep the current commitment separate from the proposed addition.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Proposal, Scope, and Client Expectations

A client requests additional sampling outside the agreed scope. The team has not assessed the extra time and cost.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: We can assess the additional sampling as a scope change. Could we confirm the question it needs to answer, then provide the time and cost implications before agreeing to the work?

Scenario 2 | Translate the report summary for a new audience

A fictional consulting agreement covers an English technical summary. The client requests a translated spoken briefing for a community group. Language support, review, cost, and availability have not been assessed. Negotiate what proposal to seek, not the translation itself.

Role A: Consulting coordinator: identify the added language-support and briefing scope.

Role B: Client liaison: choose whether to retain the original deliverable or seek an additional proposal.

Possible opening: We can assess a translated briefing, but language support, review, cost, and availability still need agreement.

Success checks

- Separate the original summary from the new spoken service.
- Identify language and technical review needs.
- Keep cost, timing, and authorization conditional on assessment.

Add a complication: The client asks a bilingual colleague to improvise technical conclusions without review.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Phase I and Phase II Site Assessments

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: B - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

B: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

C: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

Check 2: A - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

B: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

C: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

Model response: The review is incomplete because that historical record is missing. I'll identify the information gap and its significance for the assessment rather than imply that all relevant questions have been resolved.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Sampling Plans and Data Quality

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: A - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

B: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

C: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

Check 2: C - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

B: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

C: The requested action and information are explicit.

Model response: Could the responsible team review the missing transfer record and document the resolution? I'll flag the gap in the data-quality discussion instead of treating the paperwork as complete.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Permitting and Agency Coordination

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: C - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

B: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

C: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

Check 2: B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

B: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

C: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

Model response: Could we confirm which scenario and supporting information the comment refers to? I'll draft a focused clarification question and identify our proposed response for review.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Remediation Options and Risk

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: B - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

B: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

C: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

Check 2: A - An increase of one percentage point.

A: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

B: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

C: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

Model response: The options address the problem in different ways and have different monitoring needs. Let's compare them against the agreed objectives and site conditions before recommending a preferred approach.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Regulatory Compliance and Audits

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: A - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

B: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

C: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

Check 2: C - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

B: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

C: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

Model response: Four findings have documented actions. Two still need owners and target dates. I'll make those open decisions visible in the review update and distinguish planned actions from completed ones.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Sustainability and ESG Reporting

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: The calculation does not yet support that broad claim. I'll state the included operations and reporting boundary clearly, then route the proposed wording for the appropriate review.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Community and Stakeholder Meetings

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: B - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

B: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

C: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

Check 2: A - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

B: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

C: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

Model response: The result describes the sampled locations and conditions. It does not answer every question about the wider area. We should explain the findings, their limits, and the next planned information step clearly.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Proposal, Scope, and Client Expectations

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Check 1: A - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

B: For this ordinary future condition, use present simple in the "if" clause.

C: "Reviewed" places the response in the past instead of expressing the future response.

Check 2: C - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

B: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

C: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

Model response: We can assess the additional sampling as a scope change. Could we confirm the question it needs to answer, then provide the time and cost implications before agreeing to the work?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

GHG Protocol: corporate standard

<https://ghgprotocol.org/corporate-standard>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Environmental Consulting English

Professional audience: environmental consultants, remediation managers, sustainability analysts, field scientists, permitting specialists, ESG teams, and environmental project managers

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Phase I and Phase II Site Assessments

Original fictional case: A site-assessment summary says no further questions remain, but one historical record has not been obtained.

Language workshop: Match certainty to evidence

Communication goal: Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

Language guidance: Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): The available evidence shows ... / This may indicate ..., but ... / We have not yet established whether ...

Vocabulary: Phase I ESA: An environmental site assessment reviewing records and site information to identify relevant environmental concerns. / REC: Recognized environmental condition: a defined environmental-assessment term concerning hazardous substances or petroleum at a property. / Phase II: A further environmental investigation often involving sampling to assess concerns identified at a site. / due diligence: Structured review of facts, risks, obligations, and evidence before a transaction, onboarding,

investment, or decision.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The review is incomplete because that historical record is missing. I'll identify the information gap and its significance for the assessment rather than imply that all relevant questions have been resolved.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Get feedback on a draft

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

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When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

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Optional second-round challenge: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The review is incomplete because that historical record is missing. I'll identify the information gap and its significance for the assessment rather than imply that all relevant questions have been resolved.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Coach my workplace writing

1. Ask me to paste my own fictional or anonymized draft and identify its reader and purpose. If the reference gives a writing task, mention that task as the default. If it is a dialogue, suggest a brief follow-up message that records its outcome and open questions. Stop and wait. Do not write the message for me first.
2. Once I supply the draft, check it against the reference. If an ambiguity changes the meaning, ask one focused question before rewriting. Do not assume that the draft is correct evidence for a new deadline, approval, diagnosis, cost or commitment.
3. Give feedback in three parts: one effective phrase with a reason; up to three priority improvements, quoting my words; and one short revision task for me. Prioritize incorrect facts or unclear action before minor grammar. For each language correction, explain why it matters to this reader. Label optional stylistic alternatives separately and preserve my level of certainty and intended politeness.
4. Stop and wait for my revision. Then compare the two attempts, identify an improvement and offer one edited version that preserves my voice and purpose. Keep the requested length; if none is specified, use 70-110 words. Explain any meaningful change rather than silently making the message stronger or more certain.
5. Close with one phrase worth reusing and a short transfer task for a different fictional reader. Wait for my attempt before providing another model.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level